Incident severity matrix

Operations teams classify every production incident with this matrix before paging anyone. Response time is measured from detection.

Severity	Example	Required action	Response time
SEV-1	Full outage of customer logins	Page the on-call lead and open a bridge call	15 minutes
SEV-2	Payments delayed for one region	Notify the duty manager and post a status update	4 hours
SEV-3	Single report export failing	Create a ticket for the owning team	2 working days
SEV-4	Cosmetic issue in the admin console	Add to the backlog	Next release

Lessons from the 2025 pilot

During the pilot the operations board reviewed SEV-2 incidents every Thursday. Their average resolution time was 9 hours, and most of the delay came from waiting for the payment provider. The board recommends rehearsing the bridge call for SEV-1 incidents twice a year.